

CLEF 2027 JOKER Track

Humor Generation, Search, and Translation

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- **Task 1: Humor Generation:** generate humorous text from a given context in English, French, and Spanish
 - Are LLMs funny? And why not?
- **Task 2: Humor-aware Information Retrieval:** retrieve short humorous texts for a query in English and Hinglish
 - Topical relevance models lukewarm, neural ranking degrades...
 - But humor-aware IR models improve!
- **Task 3: Pun Translation:** translate puns from English to French
 - Standard MT models fail: literal translation is no pun
 - But humor-aware MT models improve!

Task 1: Humor Generation



- *Task 1: Generate Humorous Text in English, French, and Spanish*
- New task on humor generation:
 - can models produce humor across languages under clear constraints?
 - assessment centered on semantic consistency, humorous effect,
 - evaluate justified adaptation rather than surface overlap
- Evaluation challenging...
 - Human evaluation of small samples.
 - LLM evaluation is indicative but imprecise.
 - Set up an LLM/chatbot arena.

- Data:

Track	Train	Test
EN	3,344	150
ES	392	151
FR	1,599	156

Train example (FR)



```
[
  {
    "id": "fr_0001",
    "lang": "fr",
    "pun_word": "barbec-ours",
    "sense_a": "barbecue",
    "sense_b": "bear",
    "keywords": ["BBQ", "cookout", "grill", "grizzly", "brown bear",
      ↪ "cub", "..."],
    "hint": "barbec-ours / barbecue + ours ~ <côtelette; grizzly;
      ↪ cuit>",
    "reference_joke": "Comment on cuit des côtelette de grizzly ? Au
      ↪ barbec-ours.",
    "reference_en": "What do you call grizzly's ribs ? A bearbecue."
  }
]
```

Task 2: Humor-aware Information Retrieval



- *Task 2: Humor-aware Information Retrieval:*
 - retrieve short humorous texts for a query in English and Hinglish
- Use case: to search for a joke on a specific topic
 - Large corpus with queries for jokes on a general topic
 - Several relevant jokes on this topic
 - Many distractor docs (new hard negatives): on topic but no joke
- New data
 - **English task:**
 - Corpus of 96,603 short documents
 - 10 train and 971 test queries
 - 4,572 relevance judgments
 - **Hinglish task:**
 - Corpus of 32,652 short documents
 - 10 train and 485 test queries
- Evaluation: traditional IR metrics (MAP, NDCG, ...)

Document examples



```
[
  {
    "id":0,
    "contents":"Why did the musician get an A+ in alphabet class?"
    ↪ Because they really knew their A!"
  },
  {
    "id":1,
    "contents":"What did the article say when it won first place?"
    ↪ 'I'm a winner!'"
  },
  {
    "id":2,
    "contents":"I lost my job at the calendar factory. Apparently, I
    ↪ didn't have the ability to work dates!"
  },
  {
    "id":3,
    "contents":"What do you call someone who's really good at
    ↪ sleeping? They have great rest-ability!"
  },
  ... ]
```

Task 3: Pun Translation



● Task 3: Translate Puns from English to French:

- preserve wordplay form
- preserve wordplay meaning
- Professional French translations of English puns, manually annotated for wordplay location
 - **Train data:** 5,838 manual FR translations of 1,405 EN puns
 - **Test data:** 6,951 new manual FR translations of 2,656 EN puns

```
{ "id_en": "en_1",
  "en": "I used to be a banker, but I lost interest",
  "fr": "J'ai été banquier mais, j'en ai perdu tout l'intérêt."}
```

- Eval:
 - Location-based metric on the ground truth new professional translations (unseen by LLMs)
 - Manual evaluation

Task 3: Data example



English pun / References + Location

OLD PHOTOGRAPHERS never die, they just lose their focus.

Un photographe ne meurt jamais, seulement, il n'a plus d'objectifs.

Un photographe, ça ne meurt pas, ça change seulement d'objectif.

Quand les vieux photographes meurent, ils trépieassent.

Les vieux photographes ne meurent jamais, ils retouchent du bois pour rester en vie.

Les vieux photographes ne meurent pas, ils perdent leurs objectifs de vue.

Les photographes ne meurent jamais, ils vont juste faire des mises au point.

Les vieux photographes ne meurent pas, mais ils attrapent des pellicules.

Quand un photographe vieillit, il ne meurt pas, mais quand même, c'est pas pareil.

Les vieux photographes perdent souvent vue de leurs objectifs et ont besoin d'une mise au point.

Les photographes ne meurent pas, seulement, ils deviennent des vieux flous.

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